SANCTUARY · COHORT REPORT

MAY
2026

A HYBRID RESIDENCY FOR BUILDERS

The May *Sanctuary*

One month. Twelve builders. A physical container in Spain woven together with an online layer — work, health, and craft held in the same frame.

12	4	8	31
BUILDERS	IRL ON THE LAND	ONLINE LAYER	DAYS

WHAT WE LEARNED

A container, not a *course*

Sanctuary gathers builders for a month to move their product and their body forward at once — under the belief that the two are the same problem. This cohort ran a deliberate experiment: take the in-person residency and weave an online layer through it, so people who facilitate online also show up on the land, and people on the land carry into the online sessions.

THE COHORT

Twelve builders

Four in person on the Spain farm — Andrej, Anna, Anya, Colin. Eight more in the online layer, joining workshops, reviews, and protocols remotely.

THE FRAME

Product × health

Each builder set their own success marker for May — a product milestone and a health protocol — then chose how they'd measure it. Self-defined KPIs, not imposed ones.

THE BET

Hybrid by design

The structural hypothesis: an IRL residency and a curated online layer can be one container, not two. Workshops became the connective tissue between them.

“

In person is super important — but it should arrive *after* self-paced and online work to be more effective. You are weaving the digital container with the OS.

RAMONA · PARTICIPANT REFLECTION · MAY 2026

Three bets on the *container*

BET 01 · STRUCTURE

A hybrid container can be one thing, not two.

WHAT WE TRIED

Curated online workshops fed the IRL residency and vice versa. People who'd only facilitated online came onto the land; people on the land carried into the online rooms.

WHAT HAPPENED

The seam held — but sequencing matters. The strongest signal: online and self-paced work should come *first*, with IRL as the deepening layer, not the entry point.

◐ Worked, with a reorder

BET 02 · CURRENCY

Workshops are the connective tissue.

WHAT WE TRIED

Participants ran sessions for each other — Ramona's Venture Architecture sprint, Stacey's user-acquisition workshop, the peptide protocol session, hot-takes.

WHAT HAPPENED

Peer-led workshops were the highest-rated moments across the board and became the main way value crossed the online/IRL line. This is the format to build around.

● Clear win

BET 03 · CAPTURE

Self-defined KPIs, measured by the OS.

WHAT WE TRIED

Each builder set their own product + health marker and how to measure it, logged against SanctuaryOS and a start/end survey.

WHAT HAPPENED

Intention-setting was strong; outcome capture was uneven — especially online, where five builders set goals but never logged a result. The OS needs to close this loop.

◐ Loop still open

Next time, in *order*

The cohort didn't fail anywhere that matters — but it taught us a sequence and a few structural fixes worth carrying into the next container.

01 · SEQUENCE

Online first, land second

Run a self-paced + online phase before anyone arrives in person, so IRL deepens existing work instead of starting cold. Ramona's reflection, confirmed across the cohort.

02 · CLOSE THE LOOP

Make outcomes mandatory

Five online builders set goals and never logged a result. Build the end-of-month check-in into the OS as a step, not a survey people forget — measure what we started.

03 · CO-STEWARDSHIP

Name the space-holder

Running the land alongside whoever manages the physical space was its own quiet workstream. Next time, define that collaboration explicitly — roles, rhythm, handoffs. `your notes to expand`

What moved, and *how far*

ROI this cohort is soft by design — users, feedback, and clarity, not revenue. The signals worth naming:

PROJECT	WHERE IT GOT TO	SIGNAL / ROI	STATUS
Compass Ankit	Live at usecompass.app. Ran user interviews and AEO/SEO; surfaced clear gaps in the product to close next.	Live · qual. user feedback gathered	LIVE
Moxa Stacey	Compiled all user-acquisition learnings into docs + a workshop. Cited by Stacey as the biggest win of her month.	moxa.money · workshop shipped	BUILDING
Venture Architecture Ramona	Format fully mapped; ran a live session as first customer discovery. MVP built for one product type, first workflow end-to-end.	Format validated · 1st discovery run	BUILDING
SanctuaryOS Andrej	The residency's own OS — dashboard, residency records, the layer the hybrid runs on. Documented this cohort end-to-end.	Container infra · powering the month	LIVE
chello Edwin	UAE rental concept. Experiment not yet run — schedule shifted with the birth of his daughter. Honest slip to next month.	Carried forward · 5 testers pending	NEXT MONTH
Local-node project Deca	Spent the month on a thorough product-vision assessment, then deliberately decided not to pursue it commercially.	Clarity as ROI · a clean no	PARKED

IRL · HOST & STEWARD

Andrej

Sanctuary & Deep Work



PRODUCT

INTENTION — START OF MAY

Complete the full scope of SanctuaryOS, tie the features together, document the cohort, and seed Deep Work revenue with Anna.

OUTCOME — END OF MAY

Ran the cohort on a live SanctuaryOS dashboard and documented it end-to-end. Tested Compass, hosted sessions, observed the collaborations the OS is meant to surface.

HEALTH

GOAL

Gain muscle & strength, reverse skin aging, improve cardio and mental balance between screen and IRL life. Tracked via weight, HRV, sleep, RHR.

RESULT

Lost ~1kg, skin improved, sleep score and body battery up. RHR ticked slightly higher. Philosophical tree-pruning and macro-conscious cooking entered the routine.

SIDE QUESTS ON THE LAND

Pruned olive trees, watered the figs, tested Compass, collected wood from the stable path.

IRL · ON THE LAND

Anna

Deep Work



PRODUCT

INTENTION — START OF MAY

Sign the first client for Deep Work, driven by daily sales outreach.

OUTCOME — END OF MAY

Month became a recovery from AI burnout while working on Deep Work and Sanctuary. The reset was the work — re-establishing a sustainable footing to build from.

HEALTH

GOAL

Find a good "Claude–life balance" — a wind-down routine before sleep, no working right up to bed.

RESULT

Recovered a deranged sleep schedule and began reversing a declining mental and physical trajectory. Found the balance she set out for. Tried peptide injections.

IN HER WORDS

“Recovered deranged sleep schedule, reversed mental and physical health trajectory. Everything was great.”

IRL · ON THE LAND

Anya

Agentic Systems

PHOTO
place here

IN PERSON · OUTCOME NOT CAPTURED

PRODUCT

INTENTION — START OF MAY

Launch agents/bots and test how to distribute them — measured by distribution and real user demand.

OUTCOME — END OF MAY

Outcome not captured

No end-of-month self-report submitted. Her mark on the cohort, though, shows up across other builders' reflections.

HEALTH

GOAL

Focus on building muscle and discipline.

RESULT

Not captured

WHAT THE COHORT SAW — VIA ANDREJ

Held the vibe of the house, drove workout accountability, guided a mountain trip, supported personal-development work, creative-directed a photoshoot, recorded videos, cut olive trees.

IRL · LAND & SPACE

Colin

Human Element · the farm



IN PERSON · OUTCOME NOT CAPTURED

PROJECT

INTENTION — START OF MAY

More functionality inside the house; time-sensitive improvements on the land and outside — measured by tasks accomplished.

OUTCOME — END OF MAY

Outcome not captured

No self-report submitted, but Colin held the physical container — the land work that made the residency possible.

HEALTH

GOAL

Regain full lower-body movement and flexibility — relative to before buying the property and taking on heavy physical labor.

RESULT

Not captured

WHAT THE COHORT SAW — VIA ANDREJ

Taught tree-cutting as a philosophy of balance, cooked great food, kept the pool clean — the steady hand holding the space everyone else built inside.

Eight more, *remote*

The online builders set real intentions; capture was lighter. Where outcomes weren't logged, that gap is itself a finding for the next container.

Ankit · Compass

OUTCOME

Compass live at usecompass.app. Product engineering, user interviews, AEO/SEO. KPI: qualitative user feedback. Clearer on the gaps to close.

Ramona · Venture Architecture

OUTCOME

Sprint format fully mapped; first customer-discovery session run; agentic architecture finalized; MVP for one product type. Health regeneration deferred.

Edwin · chello

OUTCOME

Attended Ramona's workshop (value-mapping was eye-opening). chello experiment moved to next month; skipping goal missed — welcomed a baby girl.

Justina · peptide cohort

OUTCOME

`Not captured.` Set out to validate a peptide-cohort questionnaire & facilitation structure. Per peers: helped run the peptide workshop and supported the online layer.

Stacey · Moxa

OUTCOME

Increased cardio as planned. Compiled user-acquisition learnings into docs + a workshop — her self-named biggest win of the month. Rollout & metrics pending.

Mate · Kernel Project 0

OUTCOME

Cut sweets & alcohol, raised fiber, started training, reduced TV — clearly better gut health, sleep not yet. Tracked food and TV limits. Product: not reported.

Deca · local-node project

OUTCOME

Thorough product-vision assessment, then a deliberate decision not to commercialize. Travel disrupted health routine. A clean no counts as ROI.

Lawrence · Portfolio Revamp · Tae

OUTCOME

`Not captured.` Lawrence aimed at a full-time role + a May marathon (Strava). Tae appeared in peer reflections only — minimal touch this cohort.

What the room *felt* like

Across the reflections, the same note repeats: people felt less alone. The cohort surfaced that founders drift off-course less from bad strategy than from the relational patterns they carry into their ventures — and that a safe, in-person space is what lets those patterns be seen and re-patterned.

PEER-LED VALUE

Ramona's Venture Architecture and Stacey's acquisition workshop were named, unprompted, as standout moments.

BELONGING

“A founder like me does not feel alone in the challenges in front of us.” — Edwin

LAND AS METHOD

Olive trees, cooking, the pool, the mountain trip — shared physical work became the connective tissue between builders.

THE THESIS, CONFIRMED

A safe space to see your own patterns is why Sanctuary exists — and why Compass and the OS matter as tools for it.





The next *container*

DESIGN CHANGES

Sequence & close the loop

— Online + self-paced phase before anyone lands in person
— IRL as the deepening layer, not the entry point
— End-of-month outcome capture built into SanctuaryOS as a required step
— Name the space-holder collaboration explicitly

THE ASK

Where we want help

— Builders for the next cohort — online-first, then on the land
— Peptide & health protocol partners to deepen the health arc
— Space partners — properties that can host an IRL residency
— Early conversations with capital who see the model

Builders are free. Capital makes it sustainable.